health
Department:
Health
North West Provincial Government
REPUBLIC OF SOUTH AFRICA

2030 NDP

WITRAND HOSPITAL

"Your satisfaction is our concern"

RE A TSWELELA

INTERNAL NEWSLETTER: SPECIAL EDITION JULY 2024

WITRAND HOSPITAL HONORS NURSES IN HEARTFELT CELEBRATION

#IRON MAN/WOMAN

TABLE OF CONTENT

1 Message from the CEO
2/3 Witrand Hospital honors Nurses in heartfelt celebration
4 Food Service Inspection.
5/6 JST Hospital Benchmark Visit.
6 Hospital Inspecttion
7/8 Strategic Planning Retreat at Witrand Hospital
9/11 Grievance Procedure
12 Sexual Harassment in the Workplace: Policy Implication.
13 Witrand Physio Ward hosts exiting iron man/woman activity.
14 Hypertension Awareness
15 Mrs D Ngaba's farewell
17 Personel Development Program
18/19 Witrand Hospital Round table on NHI
20 Mens Mental Health
21 Corner Media

Mr. Nico Masiu
AD: Communications
Editor & Photography

Ms. Pako Lencwe
Intern Communications &
Graphic Designer

EDITORIAL COMMENT

As we pass the 1st quarter of the year, we are delighted to present a special edition of our internal newsletter, Rea Tswelela. The ICT Commission, in particular, Information management unit has proven to be one outstanding in terms of strategic planning outcomes for the financial year 2023/2024, strategic planning Lekgotla.

We are thrilled to share this content with you, our dedicated staff, as a testament to your unwavering commitment and hard work has indeed contributed to the growth and success of our Hospital.

According to Hospital Management, your efforts have not gone unnoticed, and we are grateful for your dedication to providing exceptional care and services to our patients.

In the following pages, we will share the highlights of the past quarter, celebrating our accomplishments and challenges as well as the staff outstanding contributions. So, let us take a moment to reflect on our journey so far.

In the next Issue, we will share with you the outcomes of the provincial performance awards based on annual performance plan indicators and audit outcomes.

Enjoy this publication!

Editorial Details
Communications Unit @ CEO's Office
All correspondence should be sent to:
Physical Address: 02 Deppe Street
Dassierand
Potchefstroom
2531

Postal address: Witrand Hospital
Private Bag x 253
Potchefstroom
2520

Witrand Specialized Hospital
Contact person: Mr. Nico . Ratlauana Masiu
AD: Communications.
Contact Details:
Tel: 018 294 9100 / 9108

www.witrandhospital.gov.za
Fax: 018 294 7069
Email :Rmasiu@nwpg.gov.za
:Witrandceo@nwpg.gov

WITRAND HOSPITAL HONORS NURSES IN HEARTFELT CELEBRATION

Witrand Hospital celebrated nursing excellence and pledged their promise as the backbone of quality patient care. Dedicated professionals to the well being of all and continued compassionate caregivers..

In a poignant tribute to the backbone and biggest component in Witrand Hospital recently hosted a jubilant Nurses Day Celebration at the Witrand Hospital Recreation Hall. The event, attended by approximately 120 nurses, was a resounding success, aimed at recognizing and commemorating the tireless efforts and invaluable contributions of nurses to communities far and wide.

Mrs. Moipone Mpolokeng, CEO of Witrand Hospital, expressed the significance of the occasion, stating, "The purpose was to celebrate the Witrand Hospital anchors of the health system, and to acknowledge the sacrifices and invaluable contributions that nurses deliver to our communities." She shared the story of her life as part of motivating nurses to be the best they can to climb the career ladder (She further said "I am a living testimony, as I am a nurse by profession").

Mrs. Mpho Gorekwang, Deputy Director of Nursing at the hospital, echoed these sentiments, emphasizing that nursing goes beyond mere tasks to embody a spirit of compassion and a desire to make a difference in the lives of patients. "We often think of nursing as giving medicines on time... Too often, we forget all the other things that make our job what it truly is: caring and having the desire to make a difference," she remarked.

Some of Nurses who are anchors of Witrand Health System during Witrand Nurses Day Celebration.

During the celebration, Mr. Kagisho Leeuw, Operational Manager, and Speaker of the day, offered words of gratitude and encouragement to the nursing staff, urging them to continue dedicating themselves to the care of those in need. He expressed his appreciation for the nurses' unwavering commitment and acknowledged their role in shaping his career.

The event also featured poignant moments of remembrance, as Sr. Shelly Daniels led the Nurse's Pledge, accompanied by candlelight. Ms. Molly Serobatse, Assistant Director of Quality Assurance, explained the symbolism behind the candle, representing both the enduring light that nurses bring to their patients and a tribute to those who have passed on.

Nurses who participated were also spoiled with goodies from our business stakeholders and celebrated with the Hospital to make Nurses day celebration a reality.

The celebration was made possible through the support of business stakeholders, who generously sponsored gifts for all participants. Mrs. Elizabeth Leeuw, a veteran of Witrand Hospital, shared words of wisdom gleaned from her long and illustrious nursing career, encouraging nurses to continually educate themselves and leave a lasting legacy for future generations.

Witrand Hospital acknowledge Matla Trust's RMA who sponsored Witrand and made the nurses day celebration possible.

Metropolitan life business stakeholders for always making sure our staff wellness programme is always bearing fruits.

Proudly sponsored by the following business stakeholders:

AVBOB METROPOLITAN ASSUPOL RMA Caring | Compassionate | Compensation

SPAR Baillie Park OLDMUTUAL Sanlam ABSA Mooirievier Mall

NATIONAL FOOD SERVICE INSPECTION

Team from National and Provincial Dept of Health Nutrition inspect food service during support visit.

Recently, National Department of Health and Nutrition as part of the strategic Health Programmes conducted an inspection for food service management and compliance on the 2nd of May 2024.

The main aim of the support visit is to monitor the implementation of the Food Service Management contract and also challenges experienced.

Food service was not only focusing on food services items but also included administration issues.

The outcomes of assessment preliminary indicated that Witrand Food service Unit scored 84% against a target of 75% . Already the food service unit is implementing some improvement plans.

"We will continue to work with the Food service Management, Staff and Dietitians on non-compliance issues" said Mr . Madome Manyuha; National Dept of Health Nutrition Directorate

JST BENCHMARK AT WITRAND HOSPITAL PHYSICAL MEDICINES REHABILITATION UNIT.

Mrs. Moipone Mpolokeng; CEO of Witrand Specialised Hospital welcome and give brief presentation about Witrand and The Rehabilitation Services during the JST Hospital Representatives, visit for banchmark at Physical, Medicine and Cardiovascular Rehabilitation Unit Services.

Job Shimankane Tabane Hospital recently undertook a benchmark visit at Witrand Hospital Physical Medicines Rehabilitation Unit which treats patients with Stroke, Head and Spinal cord injuries. JST Hospital plans to open an emergency spinal and head injury unit.

"These benchmarks serve as a starting point for evaluating the requirements for JST Hospital to open a Spinal Cord and Head Injury Unit. It also gave JST hospital a better observation of the performance of Witrand Hospital Rehab Unit for Spinal Cord and Head Injury, and the best practices." Added Dr. Laubscher .

Due to Spinal Cord Injury (SCI) or Traumatic Brain Injury (TBI) devasting long-term dysfunctions may occur. Physical, emotional, and financial hardships may follow.

Best ripple mattres to keep patient not only comfortable and absorbing pressure, but helps to avoid bed sores

Patients are often overwhelmed by the new life adaptation. Hence the need to deal with the advanced Rehabilitation Technology that Helps Spinal Cord and Brain Injury patients to rehabilitate them back to their normal lives.

JST Hospital wishes to establish such Spinal Cord Injury (SCI) or Traumatic Brain

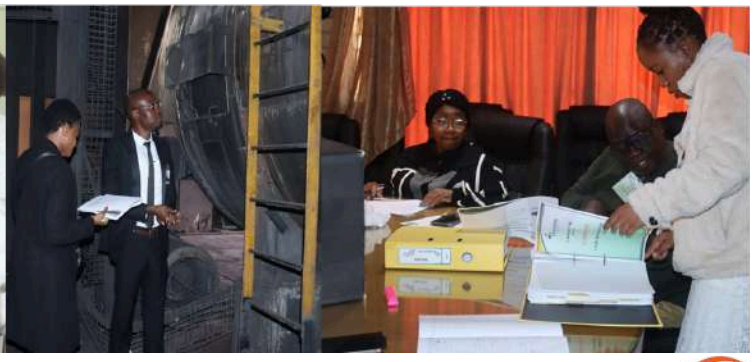
Benchmark delegates from Job Shimakene Tabane Hospital was well received by Witrand Hospital management and Physical Medicine Rehab unit led by Mrs. Moipone Mpolokeng, Witrand Hospital CEO(Front row, second from left)

Injury (TBI) Unit for the people of Bojanala District. This unit should provide diagnostic and treatment technology for patients and create new hope during recovery at the same time, dealing with the scourge of spinal cord injuries and head injuries which are the second leading cause of paralysis in our communities.

Spinal cord damage can cause a sudden loss of motor function, range of motion, sensation, and strength. Depending on the location and the severity of the damage, the patient can experience mild to moderate limitations in the legs, arms or the whole body. The damage can occur due to an accident or an illness.

Hospital Inspection, 23, July 2024

Witrand Hospital Inspection went successfully. The preliminary results indicates all systems go; The hospital is run effectively and efficiently.



STRATEGIC PLANNING RETREAT AT THE ROOTS CAFE TO DEFINE PRIORITIES FOR 2024/2025

Witrand Hospital Management team, Staff, Hospital Board and organised labor union came together to participate in the "Lekgotla" Strategic Planning Session at The Roots, in Potchefstroom from the 5th to 7th June 2024.

The Witrand Hospital team recently gathered for a three-day strategic planning retreat at The Roots in Potchefstroom, led by CEO Mrs. Moipone Mpolokeng. The retreat brought together executive management, middle managers, hospital board and organised labor representatives to reflect on the hospital's past performance and set priorities for 2024/2025 within the allocated budget.

During the Lekgotla Strategic Planning session, participants engaged in comprehensive discussions to evaluate the hospital's performance in the previous year, reassess priorities, and develop strategies for the upcoming fiscal year. Upcoming fiscal year informed by the strategic plan, annual performance plan and the Hospitals & Clinical support services Branch resolutions of the Department of Health North West.

"I am profoundly humbled to lead one of the best teams in the North West Province in the provision of Specialized Psychiatric services and a centre of excellence in the area of information management." Said Mrs Mpolokeng.

Throughout the strategic planning session, the teams engaged in team-building exercises aimed at promoting collaboration by bringing together a divers range of stakeholders and guests from the Department of Health North West who presented on finance, budget and auditor general findings and whose insights proved valuable in shaping our direction towards the realisation of the vision of the Hospital.

The journey we have travelled so far..

The following focus areas were prioritised:

1. **Human resource management**
- Filling of various vacant posts.
- Reduction of vacancy rate from 25% to 14.6%

2. **Human resource development**
- Full time and part time study leave offered to various employees.
- Trainings also provided to improve the skills of employees.

3. **Supply chain management**
- Some critical posts filled in supply chain as part of addressing some of the auditor general findings.
- On track with implementation of remedial actions and currently at 80%.

4. **Project management**
- Various projects underway within the allocated maintenance budget

5. **Stakeholder engagement**
- A functional and effective Hospital board which plays an oversight role on behalf of the MEC for the provision of services to the communities in the North West Provence
- Planned radio slots for 2024/2025

Witrand Hospital's focal points for the fiscal year 2024/2025 include, but are not restricted to, the following:

- Upgrading outdated IT infrastructure by procuring new equipment and expanding network coverage.
- Enhancing records management by transitioning to electronic systems, expanding training platforms and improving storage and implementing an Electronic Patient Record System to optimize patient care and administration.
- Establishing Forensic outpatient Services to streamline healthcare delivery.
- Strengthening Medico-Legal Management to enhance patient care and efficiency.
- Fostering a harmonious work environment, improving human resource management, and optimizing resource allocation to reduce vacancies and improve value for money.

This way, the hospital aims to create a harmonious and productive work environment that benefits both employees and patients.

- With regards to customer relations management, we intend to meet the users' expectations by ensuring easy access and availability of services, fostering strong stakeholder relationships, and developing a comprehensive communication strategy to effectively engage with patients, families, and the wider community.

Mr Richard Ramadisa, Rev Siphiwe Ndebele(Both board members), with Dr Isaac Wana (Snr Manager Medical Services), and Mrs. Moipone Mpolokeng (Chief Executive Officer -Fifth from left) hand over thank you presents to our quest speakers from Head Office: Mr Shonisani Ndou (Director Risk Management), Mr Itumeleng Tswaile (Director Budget Planning), Mr Thabo Rasodi (Director Internal Control), Mr Kgotso Rabanya (Director Policy and Planning).

- Lastly, Witrand Hospital is committed to improving audit outcomes by ensuring accurate and reliable performance information, demonstrating its dedication to transparency and accountability in delivering quality healthcare services.
- To augment the limited allocated Hospital budget, the hospital is focused on revenue enhancement initiatives to improve its financial sustainability.
- Furthermore, the hospital is investing in infrastructure management and development through its Hospital Enhancement Programme, which includes the refurbishment and standardization of the Mental Health Unit (Forensic Outpatient Services) and the OPD, as well as strengthening health information.
- management systems through the installation and roll-out of the Health Patient Registration System (HPRS). These initiatives aim to improve the overall quality of healthcare services delivered to patients.
- Witrand Hospital will this year be striving to achieve ideal hospital status by implementing promulgated norms and standards, which will significantly improve customer care and treatment.
- Lastly, Witrand Hospital is committed to improving audit outcomes by ensuring accurate and reliable performance information, demonstrating its dedication to transparency and accountability in delivering quality healthcare services.

During the strategic planning session, the teams participated in team-building activities that fostered collaboration and unity. The strategic plan brought together a diverse group of stakeholders, including special guests from head office who imparted invaluable information and assisted in shaping our direction as a Hospital.

On the last day of the strategic plan, all attendees solemnly pledged to uphold the Batho Pele Service Standards and institutionalising the Masupatsela Charta.

WORKSHOP ON SEXUAL HARASSMENT IN THE WORKPLACE

Mr. Daniel Mcameni: Assistant Director: Employment Relations recently presented a workshop on sexual Harassment in the workplace to create an enabling and barrier-free Witrand hospital that is non- sexist, and non-discriminatory.

Witrand Hospital, in its quest to promote a workplace free of sexual harassment, sexual favors, intimidation, and victimization, aims to create an environment where employers and employees respect each other's integrity, dignity, privacy, and right to equality.

The Employment Relations Manager, Mr. Daniel Mcameni, has decided to provide a systematic and consistent approach to managing sexual harassment and share steps to be taken when such incidents occur within the department.

This is one way to create an enabling and barrier-free workplace that is non-sexist and non-discriminatory.

An employee found guilty of sexual harassment should be dismissed. Additionally, falsely accusing a fellow employee of sexual harassment is a serious offense that can also lead to dismissal.

Assistant Director: Employment Relations Mr. Daniel Mcameni.

SEXUAL HARASSMENT IN THE WORKPLACE

Sexual harassment policy applies to all people who work in or have dealings with Witrand Hospital and or the Department of Health North West.

Sexual harassment in the workplace is unwelcome or unwanted behaviour of a sexual nature by a colleague or employer of the same gender or opposite gender which may be obvious or subtle.

The behavior usually causes the other person to feel offended. Depending on the extent of the behavior, this can also cause distress in the person, which can lead to emotional, physical, and social discomfort or interfere with the person's work performance.

FORMS OF SEXUAL HARASSMENT;

SANCTIONS FOR SEXUAL HARASSMENT.

If the respondent is found guilty of the offense, the Head of the Department will impose disciplinary sanctions, which may include one or more of the following:

- Verbal warning
- Counselling
- Written warning
- Final written warning
- Suspension/fine
- Demotion (as an alternative to dismissal)
- Dismissal

Physical Conduct:
Unwanted touching, Sexual assault, Rape, Strip search by or in presence of opposite

NON-Verbal Forms:
Obscene gesture, Indecent exposure, Unwelcome display of sexually explicit pictures/objects.

Verbal Forms:
Verbal ubuse, Non-verbal conduct with sexual overtones, Unwelcome innuendoes, Sex related jokes or insults, Unwelcome graphic comments, Suggestive remarks about apprearance, body and clothing.

Sexual Favouritism
Rewarding only those who respond to sexual advances, Denying benefits to those who don't submit to advances

Direct Sexual Proposisitions
Victimization with sexual undertones

Quid Pro Quo Harrassment
Requesting sexual favours in return for: Employment, Promotion, Training, Discipline, Salary increment

EMPLOYER'S LIABILITY FOR SEXUAL HARASSMENT CASE.

Parameters of the law: *What happens if the employee is sexually harassed by another employee?*

Section 60 of the Employment Equity Act deals with the liability of the employer. The Head of the Department will be liable for the actions of an employee if the Head of the Department fails to take corrective measures after an incident of sexual harassment has been reported or come to the employer's attention.

The Head of the Department is liable for medical expenses, assessment, and treatment of an employee who has experienced sexual harassment as it is categorized as an occupational injury by the Compensation for Occupational Injuries & Diseases Act.
The Head of the Department is obliged to take reasonable steps to assist a complainant of sexual harassment to claim compensation accordingly if the incident has resulted in the employee developing a medical condition, e.g. post-traumatic stress disorder.

LODGING A SEXUAL HARASSMENT COMPLAINT:

a. Procedure on How to Lodge Sexual Harassment Complaint

1. An employee who experiences sexual harassment, he/she must immediately report this to the Head of Department either in writing or verbally.
2. The Head of Department shall then appoint a Sexual Harassment Advisor to investigate the complaint. On appointment, the Sexual Harassment Advisor shall commence with the investigation and report back within the set time frames.
3. It might also be advisable to separate the respondent and the complainant to reduce the risk of tension, unpleasantness, or victimization.
4. If a false allegation is established, the Head of Department should immediately institute disciplinary processes against the accuser.

b.Informal procedure:

1. The informal procedure involves discussion and/or mediation after the matter has been brought to the attention of the Sexual Harassment Advisor.
2. If the complaint cannot be resolved and/or it is found through discussion that the incident warrants more serious action, a formal disciplinary procedure may be instituted against the respondent.
3. The informal procedure should provide the complainant with an opportunity to explain to the respondent that the behavior in question is not welcome, that it offends the complainant or makes him/her uncomfortable, and/or it also interferes with her/his work.
4. If the complainant is not satisfied with the outcomes of the informal approach, he/she may then follow a formal procedure.

c.Formal Procedure:

1. The complainant can take the option of formal proceedings to resolve a sexual harassment complaint if the harassment cannot be resolved through an informal procedure.
2. The complainant can also choose to resolve the complaint through this process without first using the informal route.
3. In dealing with the matter the complainant must first lodge a formal grievance according to the Disciplinary Code and Procedures in the Public Service.
4. The complainant must ensure that the provisions of the grievance procedure are exhausted before triggering the next process.

d.Head of Department:

1. Appoint Sexual Harassment Advisors and announce this to the Department through all communication channels of the Department.
2. Ensure training of managers, specific staff that are nominated, and those appointed to handle sexual harassment cases.
3. Submit a report on sexual harassment cases dealt with to the DPSA on half yearly basis, using the template required by the DPSA.
4. Allocate resources (human and financial) to ensure that awareness-raising and training programmes for employees on sexual harassment are implemented.
5. Encourage all trade unions within the employment of the department to include sexual harassment in their education and training programmes of members and shop stewards.

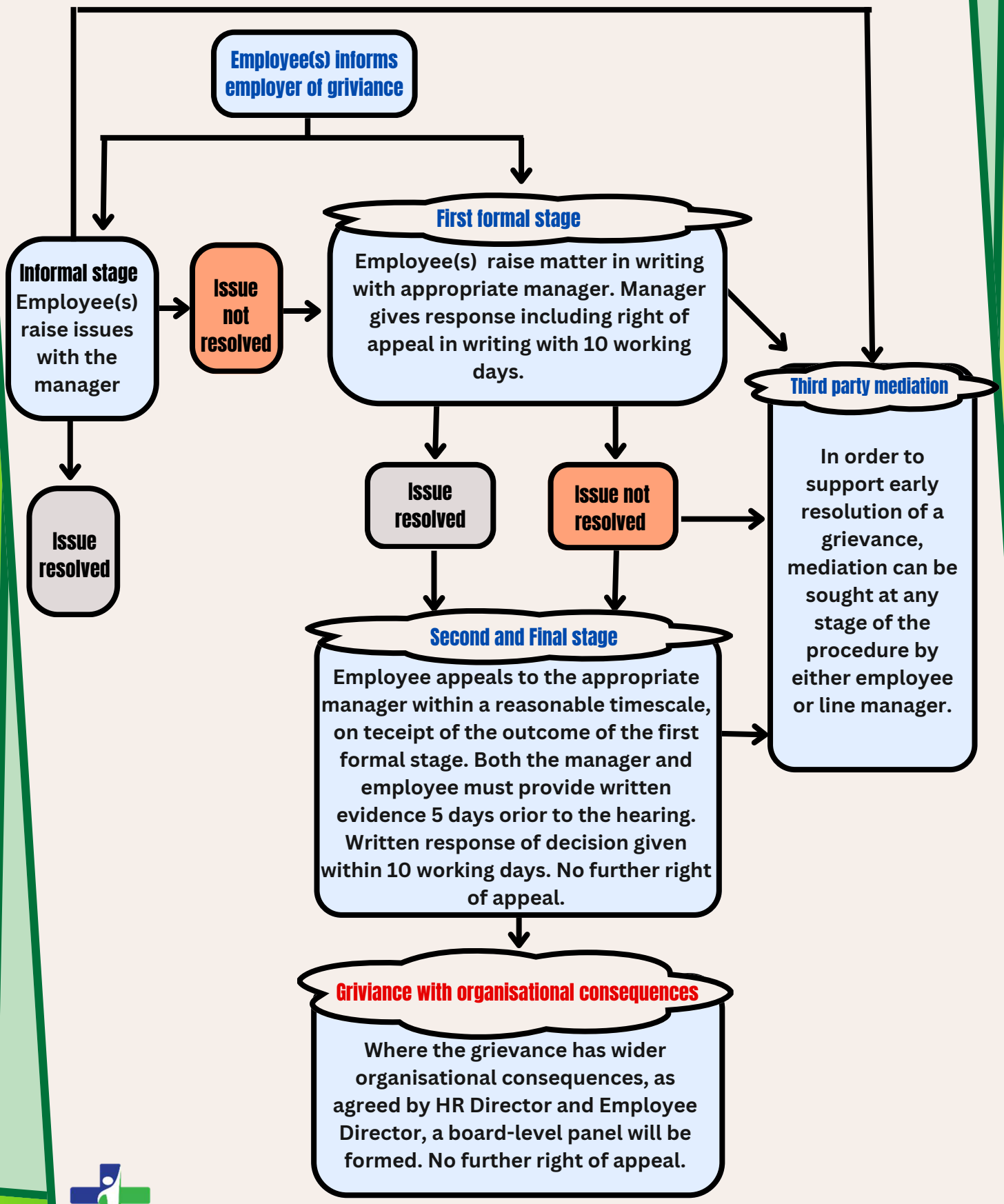
TIME FRAMES
WHEN SEXUAL HARASSMENT HAS BEEN REPORTED:

Prompt reporting of sexual harassment benefits all parties, allowing the Head of Department to address unacceptable behavior and support the complainant. Complainants are encouraged to report incidents immediately. The Head of Department must:

1. Report cases to the Compensation Commissioner within 7 days (as per Compensation for Occupational Injuries & Diseases Act)
2. Investigate and resolve complaints within 30 working days
3. Request a maximum 14-day extension if needed, with written consent from the complainant

This ensures timely reporting, investigation, and resolution of sexual harassment cases.

WITRAND HOSPITAL GRIEVANCE PROCEDURE



WITRAND HOSPITAL PHYSIOTHERAPY DEPARTMENT HOSTS EXCITING IRON MAN/WOMAN ACTIVITIES

Preparations were underway for the Iron Man/Iron Woman competition by Physio.

On May 17th, 2024, the Physio Unit at Witrand Hospital celebrated its 100th anniversary with the launch of an ambitious and spirited initiative–the #100m Iron Man/Woman Challenge. This event was part of Health Day activities, designed to encourage physical activity and promote overall health and well-being. The challenge was particularly significant as it marked a centennial milestone for Witrand Hospital, and the theme for the occasion was '#100 years of Physiotherapy.'

The challenge invited all Witrand staff to join in, and the response was overwhelmingly positive. Enthusiastic participants came from a diverse range of departments including nursing, corporate support, medical, clinical, and therapeutic support staff. The JB Marks treatment center also got involved, with teams forming from across the hospital to engage in the day's events.

The Iron Man/Woman Challenge was packed with a variety of fun and engaging activities. Among the events were a wheelbarrow race, wheelchair race, sack race, tyre race, and several other exciting challenges that embraced the celebratory theme. Each event was designed to be inclusive and enjoyable, fostering both competitive spirit and camaraderie among the participants.

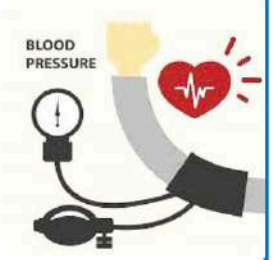
To keep everyone energized and motivated throughout the day, the participants were provided with water, oranges, and Easter eggs. Additionally, promotional items from South African Society Physiotherapy were distributed to add to the festive atmosphere. The dietetics department played a crucial role by promoting awareness about hypertension and offering health screenings, with the emphasis on health and well-being

Teamwork in motion! Some of our amazing staff members participating in the wheel-barrow challenge activity by Physio Dept.

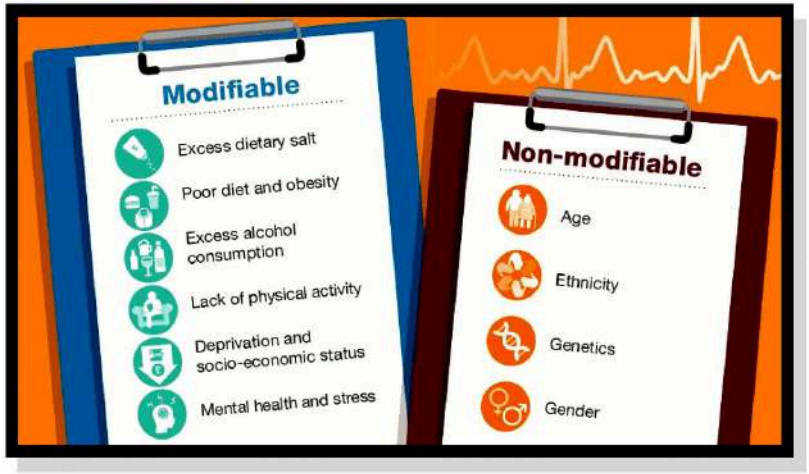
The collaborative nature of the event, involving multiple departments and support from various teams, made the day a success. It not only highlighted the importance of physical activity but also strengthened the sense of teamwork and community within Witrand Hospital. The #100m Iron Man/Woman Challenge served as a fitting tribute to a century of dedicated physiotherapy and a celebration of health and wellness for all involved.

What is Hypertension?

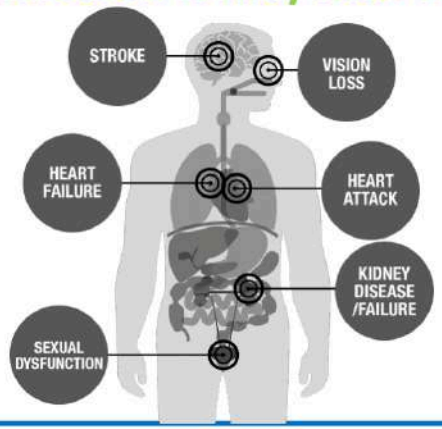
Blood Pressure is the pressure that develops in your blood vessels as blood pumps around the body by the heart. Normal blood pressure is defined as 120/80. Hypertension is defined as blood pressure 140/90. The larger the volume of blood or the smaller the blood vessels, the higher the BP becomes.



Risk factors:

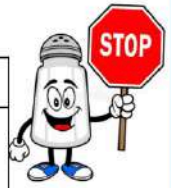


When left untreated it may lead to:



Nutrition guidelines to treat Hypertension

Limit salt and foods high in salt in your diet to less than 1tsp per day.



Allowed ✓	Avoid ✗
Ginger, garlic, herbs, turmeric, vinegar, lemon juice, fresh chillies, pepper etc	Canned foods, stock cubes, soup-powder, salted crisps, processed meats (polonies, Russians, viennas, bacon, wors) etc

- Choose 1: Cook food with little salt (either salt or spices)
- Never add extra salt to food at the table

Limit foods that are high in saturated fat, cholesterol, and trans fats.

Avoid (Harmful if taken in large quantities):

- Animal fats, butter, cream, full cream milk/yogurt, coffee creamer, pies, hard margarine, vetkoek, takeaways
- NB: Cut off meat fat and remove chicken skin BEFORE cooking
- Use low % fat margarine, or reduced oil salad dressing, use low-fat or fat-free condiments and drink low-fat or skimmed dairy products.

Eat more fruits, vegetables, wholegrains and legumes, nuts and seeds

- Add a serving of vegetables to your meals and a serving of fruit as a snack
- Add more dry beans, lentils, peas to your soups, stews, starches, meat dishes.
- Eat whole grains such as brown bread, brown rice, barley , rolled oats instead of refined grains such as white bread, rice, maize meal, pasta, cakes, doughnuts, sweets.
- Include more nuts and seeds in your diet by adding them to yogurt, salads or eat as a snack.

Maintain a healthy weight (BMI of 18.5-24.9kg/m^2)
Stop smoking and reduce alcohol intake
Exercise regularly, at least 3 times per week

A HEARTFELT TRIBUTE TO A DEVOTED COLLEAGUE AND CHERISHED FRIEND

A Bittersweet Goodbye! Staff members bid farewell to the incredible, diligent and selfless Mrs. Debbie Ngaba: Senior Social Worker. Her dedication, guidance, and long loyal service to our clients will be missed.

As Mrs. Debbie Ngaba embarks on her well-deserved retirement, we gathered to pay tribute to her extraordinary career and unwavering dedication to Witrand Hospital, spending an impressive 32 years of dedicated service. Throughout her remarkable tenure, Mrs. Ngaba has been an indispensable member of our team, consistently exemplifying exceptional work ethic, expertise, and passion. Her selfless efforts have had a profound impact on our hospital's success, leaving an indelible mark that will never be forgotten.

Dr Isaac Wana together with Social work team; Mr. Obakeng Lekaba, Ms. Carine Vorster and Ms. Boniswa Dlamini honoring Mrs. Debbie Ngaba's unwavering commitment, guidance, and mentorship, which have inspired countless colleagues.

We honor Mrs. Ngaba's unwavering commitment, guidance, and mentorship, which have inspired countless colleagues. Her generosity in sharing knowledge and experience has been instrumental in our growth, fostering a culture of excellence and collaboration. Her legacy will continue to shape the Social Work Department,
inspiring future generations to emulate her remarkable example.

We honor Mrs. Ngaba's unwavering commitment, guidance, and mentorship, which have inspired countless colleagues.

Mrs. Ngaba's dedication, leadership, and friendship have been a beacon of inspiration to us all. While she will be deeply missed, her impact will remain, a testament to her enduring influence. We extend our sincerest gratitude for her tireless service and congratulate her on this milestone occasion. May her retirement be filled with joy, love, and the knowledge that her contributions will forever be cherished.

PERSONNEL TURNOVER ON FUNDED POSTS: JULY 2024

Occupational Class	Total Approved		Filled				Vacant			
	July 23	July 24	July 23		July 24		July 23		July 24	
			No	%	No	90%	No	%	No	10%
Target	90%			90%				90%		
Medical	28	17	27	96.4	16	94.1	1	3.6	1	5.9
Nursing	473	470	422	89.2	420	89.4	51	10.8	50	10.6
Admin	66	66	58	87.9	55	83.3	8	12.1	11	16.7
Clinical Support &Therapeutic Services	63	50	51	81.0	45	90.0	12	19.0	5	10.0
Support	428	421	358	83.6	338	80.3	70	16.4	83	19.7
Total	1058	1024	916	86.6	874	85.4	142	13.4	150	14.6

PERSONNEL DEVELOPMENT PROGRAMMES 2024/2025

Section / Level / Category	MALE	FEMALE	TOTAL
Postgraduate Diploma in Health Systems Management- Executive Leadership program at University of Pretoria	1	0	1
Managers on 12 months leadership training by Aurum Institute	4	8	12
Studying to be Registrars	1	1	2
Adult Educational Training (AET) Registered learners	0	0	0
Internship Program	1	2	3
Apprenticeship Program	0	0	0
Internal Experiential Learners	0	3	3
EPWP Program	0	0	0
Full Time Applications for Full Time Study Leave (General) 2025	4	16	20
Full Time Study Awarded Study Leave 2024-2026 (3years studies)	0	2	2
Part Time Studies applicants for 2024	24	103	127
RPL D3 beneficiaries 2024-2026 (3years studies)	0	2	2
RPL potential (stand-by) candidates	0	3	3

WITRAND SPECIALIZED HOSPITAL SHINES IN NW PROVINCE

One of the Auditors from AGSA, Mr Athenkosi Mkhungela (Third from left) who recently audited Hospital pose with Witrand Information Management Team: Onkabetse Ntasi (Data capture), Kholeka Gabayo (Data capture), Thabang Ramashala (Data Capture, Mariette Ferreira(Assistant Director: Information Management) and Winnie Bowen (Senior Hospital Information Officer) during the audit of the Hospital records and Data Management.

Witrand Specialized Hospital is recognized among the top-performing hospitals in the North West Province, receiving an award in the Audit of Performance Information for 2023/2024 held in Sun City, Rustenburg on the t 21-23 August 2024.

The Hospital's excelled in the 1st Quarter performance of the APP for 2024/2025, achieving 100% in all indicators.

Witrand Hospital's Outstanding performa-nce was acknowledged by the Witrand Hospital's Outstanding performance was acknowledged by the Auditor General of South Africa, who commended the Hospital's commitment and efficient management delivering quality patient care in the Hospital.

The Management and staff were thrilled with this achievement, which reflects their dedication to prioritizing patients' need and serving them with dignity. They aim to maintain this high standard of performance.

This recognition sets a milestone in Witrand Hospital's History, solidifying its reputation as a leading healthcare provider in the District and Province.

The Hospital participated and was awarded based on the following categories:

Category: Annual Performance Plan for 1st Quarter 2024/2025.

Witrand Hospital was awarded a trophy for best performing Regional Hospital for consistently receiving 100% on the 11 indicators.

APP Indicator	Target 2024/25	Performance 1st Q 2024/25
1. Complaints resolution rate	≥95%	100%
2. Complaint Resolution within 25 working days rate	≥95%	100%
3. Average Length of Stay	100 - 300 days	128 days
4. Inpatient Bed Utilisation Rate	70 – 80%	75,7%
5. Expenditure per patient day equivalent (PDE)	R1300 – R2500	R2 062,20
6. Inpatient Crude deaths rate	<2%	1%
7. Mental health involuntary admission rate	≤15%	5,6%
9. Severity assessment code (SAC) 1 incident reported within 24 hours rate	≥90%	100%
10. Patient safety incident (PSI) case closure rate	≥90%	100%

Category : Auditor General of SA: 0utcomes 2023/2024; RFI Register

Witrand was awarded a trophy among the best performed institutions on the following: Human Resource Management, Finance, Revenue & Supply Chain Management ,Performance Information, and for submitting and correct required information on time.

WITRAND HOSPITAL ROUND TABLE ON NATIONAL HEALTH INSURANCE (NHI)

Dr. Isaac Wanna, Senior Manager Medical Services, led the discussion on National Health Insurance (NHI), shedding light on NHI implications and future directions.

Witrand Hospital organized a round table discussion on the National Health Insurance (NHI). The objective is to explore the possible dilemmas on implementation at Witrand Hospital. The event, held on June 24, 2024, at the Recreation Hall and hosted by Dr. Isaac Wana, Senior Manager Medical Services, featured a panel discussion consisting of Dr. Peter Siko: Specialist Physician, Dr Sharon Maitin, Specialist Psychiatrist, Dr Simon Chihanga; Senior Medical Officer, and Ms. Babalwa Tau, Senior Lecturer at North West University, Potchefstroom Campus.

The panel discussion was on predicting possible challenges and dilemmas for the hospital. About 74 Witrand Hospital staff members and Ececutive Management attended the round table discussion and actively participated.
Dr Wana, who was the host and facilitator of the event, presented the hospital expectation and its possible dilemmas on NHI.

Dr. Wana during the facilitation of panel discussions explained that the recently signed NHI Bill aims to provide Universal Health Coverage for all South Africans, as mandated by the Constitution of the Republic of South Africa, which recognizes healthcare as a fundamental human right.
Dr. Siko described NHI as a health financing system designed to pool funds to ensure access to quality and affordable healthcare services based on health needs, irrespective of socio-economic status.

The panel emphasized that NHI will cover all South Africans, regardless of employment status or income level, funded through general taxes to ensure comprehensive coverage.
As to how contributions towards NHI Fund will be done, further details will be clarified through upcoming regulations.

Staff members gathered for the NHI round table discussion, exchanging ideas and expertise to drive positive change in healthcare.

The discussion also highlighted improvements in healthcare standards, with updates to the National Health Act to establish the Office of Health Standards Compliance (OHSC), ensuring healthcare facilities meet required hygiene, safety, and patient care standards.

In conclusion, the panel acknowledged the forthcoming government regulations that will govern NHI operations, focusing on funding, facilities, and operational systems. They expressed optimism tempered with questions about how NHI will enhance healthcare for South Africans and its reception among stakeholders.

Dr. Wana thanked the panelists for availing themselves and sharing invaluable information on NHI.

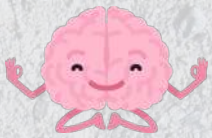
For more information on NHI, please check our NW Provincial Newsletter: READIRA: May 2024 Edition. Upcoming regulations are soon to be published by the government.

Dr. Simon Chihanga with Babalwa Tau: Senior Lecture from NWU who were part of the Round Table Panel discussions.

Dr. Isaac Wanna, Senior Clinical Manager (centre)present gifts to NHI Round Table Panelsits Dr. Sharon Maitin: Witrand Hospital Psychiatrist, Matron Mpho Gorekwang: Nursing Manager, Dr. Peter Siko; Private Specialist (panelist), Mrs. Babalwa Tau: Lecturer from NWU (panelist, Dr. Simon Chihanga: Senior Medical Officer (panelist), What a moving and quite informative discussion on National Health Insurance (NHI).

MEN'S MENTAL HEALTH MONTH

JUNE 2024

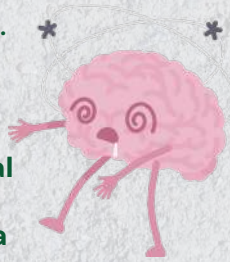


◆ COMMON CHALLENGES

MEN MAY FACE VARIOUS MENTAL HEALTH ISSUES, SUCH AS:

- **DEPRESSION:** Persistant sadness, loss of interest and feeling of hopelessness.
- **ANXIETY:** Excessive worry, panic attacks and fear.
- **SUICIDE:** Men are more likely to die by suicide than women.
- **SUBSTANCE ABUSE:** Alcohol or drug misuse as a coping mechanism.
- **STRESS:** Work-related stress, financial pressure and family responsibilities.

Mental health is essential for everyone, including men. Despite societal expectations, men experience emotional struggles and mental health challenges. Tending to these issues, like tending to a garden, can lead to fruitful growth.



◆ SIGNS TO WATCH FOR

Recognize these signs in yourself or others:

- **Withdrawal: Isolation from friends and family.**
- **Irritability: Frequent anger or mood swings.**
- **Physical Symptoms: Headaches, fatigue, or changes in appetite.**
- **Sleep Disturbances: Insomnia or oversleeping.**
- **Loss of Interest: Abandoning hobbies or activities.**

"Mental health problems don't define who you are. They are something you experience. You walk in the rain and you feel the rain, but you are not the rain."
-Matt Haig

◆ SEEKING HELP

TALK ABOUT IS: Share your feelings with someone you trust.
PROFESSIONAL SUPPORT: Consult a Psychologist.
HELPLINES: Call a mental health hotline
SELF-CARE: Prioritize sleep, exercise and nutrition.

◆ BREAKIN STEREOTYPES

- **it's Okay To Seek Help**: Real strength lies in vulnerability.
- **Emotions Are Normal**: Supressing feelings harms mental health.
- **Support Each Other**: Encourage open conversations.

WITRAND PSYCHOLOGY DEPARTMENT

PHYSICAL ADDRESS: ***Witrand Hospital, 02 Deppe street, Potchefstroom 2531***
CALL US ***: 018 294 9100***
EMAIL ***: info@witrandhospital.gov.za***

THROUGH THE LENS

Delegates from JST Hospital Visits Witrand Rehab Centre for benchmark.

Food Service Inspection went well.

Witrand Staff Actively participated during NHI round Table discussion.

some of our employees who attended Strategic Lekgotla

Food Service Inspection t the renovated main Kitchen

New Staff members Who Recently Joint us

Former Parents Association and Friends Executive members during recent Meeting

Leadership Commission during Lekgotla

Hospital Management welcomes New Staff members

Mr. O.J Moholo facilitating Lekgotla session

Witrand Nurses Day Celebration: we would like to say thank you to all business stakeholders who made our event a memorable one.

Hospital CEO: Mrs. M.E. Moipone

Hospital Staff members health & wellness activities during the 1 quarter 2024 lead by our Physiotherapy Dept

Witrand Hospital Staff members health & wellness activities during the 1st quarter 2024 organized by Physiotherapy Department

Editorial Details
Communications Unit @ CEO's Office
All correspondence should be sent to:
Physical Address: 02 Deppe Street
Dassierand
Potchefstroom
2531

Postal address: Witrand Hospital
Private Bag x 253
Potchefstroom
2520

Witrand Specialized Hospital

Contact person: Mr. Nico . Ratlauana Masiu
AD: Communications.
Contact Details:
Tel: 018 294 9100 / 9108
Fax: 018 294 7069
Email :Rmasiu@nwpg.gov.za
:Witrandceo@nwpg.gov.za

www.witrandhospital.gov.za

We welcome your comments, Inputs & suggestions for the improvement of this publication & the hospital in general. Do not hesitate to contact the Communications Unit or the CEO's Office.

health
Department:
Health
North West Provincial Government
REPUBLIC OF SOUTH AFRICA